



"Tragic Hero",
August 13, 2007

"The commendable verdict in Dutt's case proves that the law of the land is supreme and does not distinguish between a celebrity and commoner."

K.L. VENKATRAMAN, *Nagpur*

Fall from Grace

For all our sympathies, Sanjay Dutt's Bollywood or political connections should not be allowed to interfere with the process of law ("Tragic Hero", August 13). Judge Kode's observation that the element of criminality in him is incurable, says it all.

S.C. KAPOOR, *Noida*

Dutt has been a person of national and international eminence and has had no bad antecedents. He committed the offence out of sheer idiocy and should have been dealt under the Probation of Offenders Act.

S. JAMAL AHMAD, *Patna*

While Dutt has been a subject of public sympathy, there has been no such outpouring of emotions for politicians like Shibu Soren. Here's a lesson for our politicians: improve your public image or the masses would

continue to hate you.
MAN MOHAN BHATIA, *Delhi*

It was a proud day for our judiciary when Dutt was incarcerated. But the day they punish the criminals in politics, the judiciary would make us more proud. Dutt's crime pales before the misdeeds of our lawmakers

APARNA PAL, *Delhi*

Though Dutt's conviction has cast a pall of gloom on the filmmakers, there is no need to shed tears on his fate. However, the media's maniacal obsession with his case is quite surprising. It seems to be propagating a perception that he is a "victim of circumstances". We need to follow the West's example which does not hesitate in putting celebrities behind bars for their crimes.

ARVIND K. PANDEY, *Allahabad*

Six years in jail seems to be too long a punishment for a

person of impeccable credentials as Dutt. Was he given a harsh sentence to prove that everyone is equal in the eyes of the law?

RAJNI HIRA, *on e-mail*

Queen G

Not being the prime minister of the country has made Sonia Gandhi the most powerful woman in the world today ("Maximum Leader", August 13). The invitation to address the United Nations just proves this point.

A. JACOB SAHAYAM,
Thiruvananthapuram

It is good to know that Sonia has finally come out of her shell and has become more accessible and political savvy. This will only help her in passing yet another acid test—Gujarat assembly elections.

BAL GOVIND, *Bareilly*

The Gandhi family, with Sonia as the wily matriarch, is nothing but an

aristocratic family which has not only survived democracy, but flowered on it too.

SONAM CHAWLA, *Delhi*

Communist Doublespeak

The agitation against delay in land reforms by the Marxists in Andhra Pradesh raises a fundamental question: will the Communist Government in West Bengal introduce such reforms in their state where farmers have been agitating since long ("Landing in Deep Pit", August 13)? It would be better for the comrades if they practised what they preach.

ASOKE C. BANERJEE, *Kolkata*

People are no strangers to Communist doublespeak, especially since 2004, when the CP(M) led the Left parties into embracing the Congress. But nothing can come close to the political burlesque that is on in